

DOCUMENT 48

CORPORATE PROPOSAL CUSTOMIZATION SYSTEM

A Repeatable Workflow for Building Company-Specific \$100K-\$250K Sponsorship Proposals

Purpose: Turn the major-partnership architecture in Document 47 into a controlled proposal-production system. Fellows should be able to prepare most of a sophisticated corporate proposal efficiently while leadership retains authority over strategy, financial asks, negotiation and final commitments.

CUSTOMIZE THE BUSINESS CASE — NEVER JUST CHANGE THE COMPANY NAME AND LOGO.

1. THE 10-STEP PROPOSAL FACTORY

#	Stage	Required Action
1	Qualify	Confirm prospect is sufficiently engaged/qualified for a proposal.
2	Research	Verify current priorities, programs, geography, pathway and decision team.
3	Discovery Notes	Translate what the prospect said into priorities, needs and constraints.
4	Strategic Match	Choose the strongest Challenge outcome that connects to those priorities.
5	Investment	Select \$100K, \$150K, \$250K or an approved custom level.
6	Industry Module	Select finance, AI/tech, healthcare, travel, retail, etc.
7	Activation	Choose only deliverable sponsor/student/employee activations.
8	Measurement	Choose KPIs the program can reliably track.
9	Review	Leadership checks ask, promises, data, budget, legal/privacy issues and quality.
10	Deliver & Track	Send approved version; record version, date, decision process and next action.

2. REQUIRED RESEARCH INPUTS

Input	What Must Be Known
Company priority	Current official youth, education, workforce, community, industry or social-impact priority.
Relevant program	Current initiative that demonstrates alignment; do not assume it funds this Challenge.
New York relevance	HQ, employees, operations, customers, local philanthropy or community footprint.
Decision team	Verified department and, where possible, legitimate contact/decision-maker.
Funding/pathway	Grant, sponsorship, foundation, corporate affairs, marketing, local market, etc.
Timing	Budget/application/decision timing discovered or verified.
Prospect language	Words the company itself uses to describe its priorities.
Discovery evidence	What the prospect explicitly said matters to them.
Restrictions	Geography, eligibility, audience, brand, legal, privacy or procurement constraints.
Source notes	Official source/date for material claims used in proposal.

3. PROPOSAL BUILDER WORKSHEET

Field	Entry
Company	_____
Primary contact / title	_____
Current stage	_____
Verified priority #1	_____
Verified priority #2	_____
Discovery insight	_____
Recommended initiative	_____
Primary investment	\$ _____
Secondary investment	\$ _____
Cash / in-kind	_____

Field	Entry
Student outcome	
Sponsor activation	
Employee activation	
Top 3 KPIs	
Key restriction / risk	
Decision date	
Proposal owner / reviewer	

4. INDUSTRY MODULE SELECTOR

Industry	Strategic Theme	Working Initiative Name	Activation Menu
Banking / Payments	Financial capability + entrepreneurship	Young Entrepreneurs & Financial Capability Initiative	Financial education; business mentors; digital commerce; career exposure.
Technology / AI	AI/STEM + future skills	Future Problem-Solvers & AI Skills Initiative	Responsible AI; STEM experts; technology resources; workforce exposure.
Telecom	Digital inclusion + connectivity	Connected Future Problem-Solvers Initiative	Digital skills; connectivity; devices where approved; technology careers.
Healthcare / Pharma	Health careers + STEM	Future Healthcare Problem-Solvers Initiative	Career panels; science/health education; workforce exposure.
Insurance	Financial resilience + risk	Future Ready & Financial Resilience Initiative	Financial wellness; risk awareness; careers; preparedness.
Airline / Travel	Aviation careers + opportunity	Future Aviation & Workforce Opportunity Initiative	Career exposure; approved travel experiences; workforce education.
Hospitality	Hospitality careers + experiences	Future Hospitality Leaders Initiative	Career exploration; hotel operations; customer experience; approved stays.
Retail / CPG	Community + workforce + families	Community & Local Business Problem-Solvers Initiative	Local commerce; workforce skills; products/experiences where useful.
Professional Services	Business skills + mentorship	Future Business Leaders Initiative	Mentors; consulting/business skills; career readiness.
Media / Entertainment	Storytelling + creativity	Student Storytellers & Creative Careers Initiative	Media careers; content skills; storytelling; creative experiences.
Automotive / Mobility	STEM + mobility	Future Mobility Problem-Solvers Initiative	Engineering; mobility; transportation careers; safety.
Energy / Utility	STEM + sustainability	Future Energy & Sustainability Leaders Initiative	Clean-energy careers; STEM; sustainability; resilience.

5. INITIATIVE NAMING FORMULA

[Future/Young/Connected/Community] + [Relevant Identity/Skill] + [Impact Word] + Initiative. The name should sound natural for the company and program, not like a forced advertisement. Avoid using a company's trademark inside a program title until permission is obtained.

6. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY FORMULA

Paragraph 1 — Mission: What the Student Impact Challenge enables students to do.

Paragraph 2 — Alignment: Why this company's verified priorities connect to the opportunity.

Paragraph 3 — Recommendation: The proposed initiative, investment and intended outcome.

Paragraph 4 — Partnership: How the company can participate and how impact will be measured.

7. “WHY [COMPANY]” FORMULA

Use three pieces of evidence: (1) one current verified corporate priority; (2) one relevant New York/community/business connection; and (3) one discovery insight from the prospect. If the team cannot fill all three, the proposal may be premature.

8. INVESTMENT SELECTION LOGIC

Level	Use When	Structure
\$250K	Exceptional strategic fit + capacity + meaningful multi-component scope + senior engagement.	Flagship / Founding Impact
\$150K	Strong fit + major defined initiative + credible budget pathway.	Leadership Impact
\$100K	Strong fit + defined component + meaningful activation.	Major Impact
\$50K-\$99K	Qualified opportunity but narrower budget/scope.	Custom approved major partnership
<\$50K	Use appropriate sponsorship architecture; do not force a \$100K package.	Growth / supporting partnership

9. ACTIVATION MENU

Activation Type	Examples
Executive	Panel, career conversation, keynote-style educational participation, approved event role.
Employees	Mentors, judges, volunteers, experts, career speakers—subject to program rules.
Education	Workshop, resource, curriculum-support content or skills session.
Student Experience	Career visit, approved tour, learning experience, finalist/winner opportunity.
Community	Sponsor-supported activation connected to the Challenge mission.
Digital	Approved educational content, sponsor acknowledgment or program-controlled digital activation.
Awards	Scholarship/prize support consistent with program rules.
In-Kind	Technology, travel, products, services or professional expertise that fills a real program need.

10. KPI SELECTOR

KPI Family	Possible Measures
Program	Eligible registrations; active participants; completions; submissions.
Education	Workshop attendance; resources delivered; approved learning survey.
Business / Community	Interviews conducted; verified problems identified; solutions submitted.
Career	Students participating in career exposure; mentors/experts engaged.
Awards	Scholarships/prizes awarded; recipients where reportable.
Digital	Program-controlled views, clicks, registrations or scans.
Volunteer	Employees participating; verified hours where tracked.
Geographic	Verified schools/communities represented.
Qualitative	Approved student/teacher/business stories and testimonials.

11. 80% / 20% AUTHORITY MODEL

Authority	Scope
Fellow may prepare	Research notes; first draft; verified corporate facts; industry module; initiative-name options; draft activations; draft KPIs; formatting; source log.
Leadership must approve	Final investment/ask; financial claims; scope; exclusivity; naming rights; celebrity/media commitments; participant-data issues; legal terms; custom benefits; final proposal.
Operations/finance/legal review as needed	Budget feasibility; payment structure; tax documentation; privacy; insurance; agreement terms; fulfillment risk.

12. RED-FLAG AUTOMATIC ESCALATIONS

- Prospect asks for exclusivity or naming rights.
- Prospect requests participant/student/parent data.
- Prospect requests direct access to minors outside approved program structures.
- Proposal includes celebrity involvement, guaranteed media or political participation.
- Company requests unusual intellectual-property rights or ownership of student work.
- Company wants outcome, participation or reach guarantees.
- Cash ask changes by \$25K+ from approved strategy.
- Custom activation creates meaningful cost, safety, privacy or operational burden.
- Agreement contains indemnification, insurance, data, IP or other legal obligations.

13. PROPOSAL QUALITY SCORE — 100 POINTS

Factor	Points
Current company research	15
Discovery reflected accurately	15

Factor	Points
Strategic alignment	15
Clear business case	10
Investment logic	10
Program feasibility	10
Activation quality	10
Measurement plan	5
No unsupported claims	5
Executive polish / clarity	5

Tier A proposals should score 90/100 or better before they leave the organization.

14. VERSION CONTROL

Version	Meaning
DRAFT 0.1	Fellow working draft; not for external distribution.
DRAFT 0.5	Research and modules complete; awaiting strategic review.
REVIEW 0.9	Leadership/operations review; final corrections.
FINAL 1.0	Approved external proposal.
FINAL 1.1+	Approved revisions after prospect feedback.
SIGNED / CONFIRMED	Final agreed scope retained with approval/payment documentation.

15. FILE NAMING STANDARD

SIC_[Company]_[Initiative]_[Investment]_[Version]_[YYYY-MM-DD].pdf

Example: SIC_Microsoft_FutureProblemSolversAI_150K_FINAL1.0_2026-08-20.pdf

16. PROPOSAL PRODUCTION SLA

Proposal Type	Internal Standard
Standard qualified proposal	First internal draft within 2 business days after sufficient discovery.
Tier A / \$100K+	Leadership-reviewed external version targeted within 3 business days.
Complex/custom/legal-sensitive	No artificial deadline; complete required review before sending.
Prospect deadline	Work backward from stated deadline and assign owners immediately.

17. FINAL SEND CHECKLIST

- Correct company and contact throughout the document.
- Current corporate facts verified and source log retained.
- Investment matches approved account strategy.
- Cash and in-kind separated.
- All benefits are approved and deliverable.
- Metrics can actually be tracked.
- No unsupported participation/reach claims.
- No accidental competitor/company names from reused drafts.
- Dates, program rules and contact information are current.
- Leadership approval recorded.
- CRM stage, proposal value, version and follow-up date updated.

18. SYSTEM PRINCIPLE

Speed matters, but credibility matters more. The purpose of a proposal system is to remove repetitive production work so the team can spend its energy on research, relationships, strategic fit and closing. A corporation should feel that the proposal was built specifically for them—even though the organization used a disciplined internal architecture to produce it.

NEXT DOCUMENT

Document 49 — Sponsor CRM, Pipeline Dashboard & \$1M War Room Operating System. This should bring the prospect list, fellows, outreach, meetings, proposals, probabilities, cash forecast, next actions and 90-day \$1 million target into one management dashboard.

PROGRAM CONTACT

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